



AI Invoice Generator

Local Setup Guide

Follow the steps below to run the project locally after cloning it from GitHub.

1. Before You Start

- **Node.js** and **npm** should be installed. Check them with `node -v` and `npm -v`.
- **MongoDB** should be available because the backend stores application data in MongoDB.
- **Ollama** is needed for the AI invoice generation feature.
- **Git** is needed to clone the repository.

2. Clone the Project

Open a terminal and clone the repository shared on GitHub.

```
git clone - https://github.com/Shivamtiwari-9235/Invoice-Generator
```

Use the actual GitHub repository URL and project folder name here.

3. Install Frontend Dependencies

Open the frontend folder in the terminal and install the packages.

```
cd Frontend  
npm install  
npm run dev
```

Vite will show the local frontend address in the terminal. Open that address in your browser.

4. Install Backend Dependencies

Open a second terminal, move to the backend folder and install its dependencies.

```
cd Backend  
npm install
```

Start the backend using the development/start script available in the backend package.json. For example:

```
npm run dev
```

5. Ollama Setup for AI Invoice Generation

The AI invoice feature uses Ollama locally. If Ollama is already installed, continue with the model-check steps below. If it is not installed, install Ollama first from the official Ollama website and then reopen your terminal.

After installing Ollama, verify the installation:

```
ollama --version
```

If this command returns an Ollama version, the installation is available from the terminal.

6. Check Which Ollama Model Is Installed

Run the following command to see the models currently downloaded on the machine:

```
ollama list
```

The output will show the model name, ID, size and other information. The model name configured in this project should match the value used by the backend's `AI_MODEL` configuration.

To see exactly which model this project is configured to use:

Open the backend Ollama configuration file, usually something similar to `config/ollama.config.js`, and check the value assigned to `AI_MODEL`.

7. If the Required Model Is Not Installed

Once you know the exact value of `AI_MODEL`, download that model with Ollama. Replace `<MODEL_NAME>` with the exact model name shown in the project's configuration.

```
ollama pull qwen2.5:3b
```

Then verify it was downloaded:

```
ollama list
```

8. Test the Ollama Model Directly

You can quickly check whether the selected model responds before testing it through the application:

```
ollama run qwen2.5:3b
```

Enter a simple prompt in the terminal. If the model responds, Ollama and the model are working locally. Exit the interactive session when finished

9. Start the Services

Keep the frontend and backend running in separate terminals.

Terminal	Run
Terminal 1 – Backend	<code>npm run dev</code>
Terminal 2 – Frontend	<code>npm run dev</code>

Make sure MongoDB is reachable before testing database features. For AI invoice generation, make sure Ollama is running and the configured model is available.

